

Managing your Business

Science

May, 2026



Short Title:	Managing your Business	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Science	
Cluster	Business	
Author	MWAGENAAR	
Credits	5	Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module will provide students with knowledge and practical skills to prepare a business plan, distinguish between forms of business ownership, and use financial information for managing working capital, budgeting and decision making (cost-volume-profit, pricing decisions, sourcing finance) in a small business context.

Programmes

BUSS-0063	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	2 / 3 / M
BUSS-0063	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	2 / 3 / M

Indicative Content

- Business plans: purpose of business plan, difference between business plan and feasibility study, business plan tests, structure and content
- Forms of business ownership: sole trader, partnership, company
- Working capital: management of the elements of working capital in a small business (inventory, receivables, payables, cash)
- Budgeting: budget process, conflicting roles of budgeting, preparation and monitoring of cash budgets
- Decision making: cost-volume-profit (single and multi-product break-even, target profit, margin of safety)
- Decision making: pricing (price taker/setter, pricing policies)
- Decision making: sourcing finance (sources, factors influencing types and sources of finance)

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Differentiate the required elements of a business plan.
2. Distinguish between forms of business ownership.
3. Manage the elements of the working capital in a small business.
4. Employ the budgetary process and prepare and monitor a cash budget in a small business.
5. Use cost-volume-profit analysis, evaluate pricing options and determine appropriate sources of finance for a small business.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Class and group discussions.
- Pre-lecture preparation of readings and exercises for in-class participation.
- Self-study of assigned readings, exercises and texts.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	100%	1,2,3,4,5

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to carry out critical thinking or practical skills.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrates a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem solving. Adequate practical skills.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrates satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrates skilled and sound knowledge of the subject matter. Shows ability to analyse and logically discuss in an effective way. Good critical thinking and a high level of competence and efficiency in theoretical and practical areas of this subject.
- 70%-100%:** All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrates authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	48	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Atrill, P. and E. McLaney. *Accounting and Finance for Non-Specialists*. Latest Edition. Harlow: Pearson Education, Latest.

Supplementary Material

- Scarborough, N.M. and J.R. Cornwall. *Essentials of Entrepreneurship and Small Business Management*. Latest Edition. Harlow: Pearson Education, Latest.

Requested Resources

- Lecture Room: Loose Seated
- Room Type: Computer Lab